

ケア拒否への 対応

When a Resident Refuses Care — Handling It Gently — Scenario Dialogue

Can-do: Accept a resident's refusal without forcing, find the reason, offer a small easy step, and re-invite gently — protecting trust and dignity.

1 · Dialogue & Why — 会話

Hana
(caregiver)

田中さん、そろそろ お風呂の 時間ですよ。

Tanaka-san, it's about time for your bath.

Why: A normal, gentle prompt — そろそろ ('about time now') 時間ですよ ('it's time'). But care must always be offered, never imposed, so when the resident refuses (next line) you respond with patience, not pressure.

Tanaka-san
(resident)

いやよ。今日は 入りたくない。

No. I don't want to bathe today.

Why: いや = 'no / I don't want to'; 入りたくない = 'don't want to get in' (~たくない = don't want to). A refusal is a valid expression, not 'problem behaviour'. The first rule: STOP. Don't push, don't argue. Consent is the premise of all care.

Hana
(caregiver)

そうでしたか。無理には しませんよ。大丈夫です。

I see. I won't force you. It's okay.

Why: Accept the refusal immediately and out loud: 無理には しません = 'I won't force it' (無理に = 'forcibly'). Forcing (無理強い) is counter-productive — it deepens resistance and destroys trust (信頼関係). Removing the pressure first is what makes a later re-invite possible.

Hana
(caregiver)

何か 気になる ことがありますか。

Is something bothering you?

Why: Now find the reason. 気になること = 'something on your mind / bothering you'. Refusal usually has a cause — fear of cold, pain, embarrassment, 'I can do it myself', or confusion (認知症). Asking calmly (傾聴 = active listening) lets you solve the real problem.

Tanaka-san
(resident)

寒いのが 嫌なのよ。

I just don't like being cold.

Why: The real reason appears: 寒い ('cold') 嫌 ('dislike'). Now you can address it directly instead of pushing. This is why you always ask — the refusal wasn't about the bath, it was about the cold, which you can fix.

Hana
(caregiver)

お部屋を 暖かく しておきますね。先にお湯に 手だけ つけてみませんか。

I'll warm the room up for you. Shall we start by just dipping your hands in the warm water?

Why: Solve the cause (暖かくしておきます = 'I'll have it warmed up', ~ておく = do in advance) AND offer a tiny first step: 手だけ ('just your hands') つけてみませんか ('shall we try dipping?'). A small, easy step lowers resistance — once they start, the rest often follows.

Tanaka-san
(resident)

て
手だけ なら… いいわ。

Just my hands... all right then.

Why: 手だけなら ('if it's just hands') いいわ ('okay') — the small step worked. Never celebrate too loudly or rush; keep it calm and let her keep control of the pace. If she'd still said no, you'd withdraw warmly and try again later — patience over pressure.

Hana
(caregiver)

ありがとうございます。田中さんのペースで大丈夫ですよ。

Thank you. At your own pace is just fine.

Why: Thank her (it's her choice, and she gave it) and hand back control: ペースで ('at your pace') 大丈夫 ('is fine'). Respecting the resident's pace and choice preserves 自尊心 (self-esteem) and rebuilds the trust that makes tomorrow's care easier.

2 · Key Vocabulary — 語彙

#	日本語	ROMAJI	ENGLISH	メモ / NOTES
1	じかん 時間	jikan	time	
2	ふろ お風呂	ofuro	bath	
3	いや		no; unwilling	
4	～たくない		don't want to ~	
5	むり 無理に	murini	forcibly; against one's will	
6	する		to do	
7	き 気になる	kininaru	to bother; be on one's mind	
8	こと		thing; matter	
9	さむ 寒い	samui	cold	
10	いや 嫌	iya	dislike; unpleasant	
11	あなた 暖かい 仕事日本語 · Shigoto Nihongo	atataakai	Free video lessons on YouTube · ks-14-care-refusal warm	

12	さき 先に	sakini	first; ahead	
13	～なら		if it's ~	
14	いい		good; okay	
15	ペース		pace	
16	だいじょうぶ 大丈夫	daijoubu	okay; fine	

3・Patterns to Reuse — 使える かたち

PATTERN	MEANING & USE
無理には しませんよ	'I won't force you' — accept refusal, remove pressure first
何か 気になる ことが ありますか	'Is something bothering you?' — find the real cause
先に ～だけ ～てみませ んか	'Shall we start with just ~?' — a small, easy first step
～なら いいわ	'If it's just ~, okay' — how a lowered barrier is accepted
～さんの ペースで 大丈 夫ですよ	'At your own pace is fine' — hand back control

4・Practice — れんしゅう

Say / write it in Japanese, then check with the answer key.

#	SAY THIS IN JAPANESE	YOUR ANSWER
1	Accept the refusal: 'I won't force you. It's okay.'	
2	Find the cause: 'Is something bothering you?'	
3	Offer a small step: 'Shall we start with just your hands?'	
4	Hand back control: 'At your own pace is fine.'	
5	What must you NEVER do when a resident refuses?	

5・Answer Key — こたえ

仕事日本語・Shigoto Nihongo

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1. 無理^{むり}には しませんよ。大丈夫^{だいじょうぶ}です。

2. 何か^{なに} 気^きになる ことがありますか。

3. 先^{さき}に お湯^ゆに 手^てだけ つけてみませんか。

4. 田中^{たなか}さんの ペースで 大丈夫^{だいじょうぶ}ですよ。

5. 無理^{むり}に させること。(Force them.)